

Prompting Matters

Start with a good question. Then give AI what it needs.

01 START WITH A GOOD QUESTION

Be **open-minded**: don't pick the answer in advance. Be **specific**: give enough detail to get an answer that fits. Stay **on target**: ask about the problem you actually need to solve. Be **open-ended**: invite an explanation and leave room for an unexpected answer.

02 SHARE YOUR SITUATION

Explain what you are working on, who it is for, and why it matters.

03 GIVE IT THE MATERIAL

Include the draft, notes, assignment, rubric, or source you want it to use. Share only what the task needs.

04 DESCRIBE THE ANSWER YOU WANT

Specify the format, length, tone, and limits. Give an example when it would help.

05 ONE JOB AT A TIME

Break big work into steps. Say where AI should stop so you can review before moving on.

A REUSABLE OUTLINE

I am working on [task] for [audience or purpose].

Use [material]. Help me [specific next step].

Give me [format], with [limits].

Stop after [step] so I can review.

PUT IT TOGETHER

"I'm preparing a history presentation for my class. Here are my notes and the rubric. Suggest three possible main arguments in a short list. Use only these notes. Wait for me to choose before making an outline."

Use the moves that fit the task. A simple question may need very little setup.



A prompt is a briefing, not magic words.